

GOMTI NANDAN PUBLIC SCHOOL

UNIT TEST III (2026–27)

CLASS: CLASS 11

SUBJECT: ENGLISH CORE (301)

TIME ALLOWED: 45 Mins

MAXIMUM MARKS: 20

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS:

1. All questions are compulsory. However, internal choices are provided in specific sections.
2. The paper is strictly aligned with the prescribed syllabus (Gap Filling, Sentence Re-ordering, Speech Writing, *The Laburnum Top*, and *The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse*).
3. Adhere to the prescribed word limits. Maintain neatness and formatting.

SECTION A: GRAMMAR (4 MARKS)

Q1. (A) Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the word/clauses to complete the [2+2=4] paragraph focusing on empathy:

A simple act of kindness (i) _____ (can / must / shall / will) completely change a person's day. When we (ii) _____ (helps / helped / help / helping) others without expecting anything in return, we build a bridge of genuine human connection.

(B) Re-order the following words/phrases to make meaningful sentences:

- (i) compassion / is / language / the / deaf / hear / the / can / which
- (ii) it / connects / deeply / human / beings / beyond / words

SECTION B: LONG WRITING SKILLS (6 MARKS)

Q2. You are Aryan/Arya, Head Boy/Head Girl of your school. You have observed that in the race for academic excellence, students are becoming increasingly stressed and isolated. Write a speech in 120-150 words to be delivered in the morning assembly on the topic: "The Importance of Compassion in a Competitive World". [6]

OR

You are Raj/Riya. Frequent natural disasters worldwide have proven that humans cannot conquer nature but must live in harmony with it. Write a speech in 120-150 words for your school's Environment Day on the topic: "Living Harmoniously with Nature: Our Moral Responsibility".

SECTION C: LITERATURE (10 MARKS)

Q3. Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow:

[1x3=3]

*"Till the goldfinch comes, with a twitching chirrup
A suddenness, a startlement, at a branch end."*

- (i) What does the 'startlement' at the branch end signify regarding the relationship between the bird and the tree? **[1]**
- (ii) Identify the figure of speech used in the phrase "twitching chirrup". **[1]**
- (iii) *Multiple Choice:* The sudden arrival of the goldfinch brings a sense of: **[1]**
 - (a) Impending danger and sorrow (b) Sudden, electric vitality
 - (c) Melancholic grief and silence (d) Destructive chaos to the nest

Q4. How does Mourad's gentle, empathetic handling of the injured robin highlight a stark contrast to his supposedly 'crazy' Garoghlanian streak? **[2]**

Q5. Justify how the Laburnum tree and the Goldfinch mutually support each other in the poem, acting as a metaphor for the interdependence of nature. **[2]**

Q6. *"Honesty is more than just not stealing; it is the courage to right a wrong."* **[3]**
Analyze how Aram and Mourad ultimately uphold the moral integrity of the Garoghlanian family in *The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse*, despite their initial lapse in judgement.